the fact of membership in a group seeking anonymity, *e. g.*, *Brown* v. *Socialist Workers '74 Campaign Committee*, 459 U. S. 87, 91–92 (1982); and it may try to interfere with the internal organization or affairs of the group, *e. g.*, *Cousins* v. *Wigoda*, 419 U. S. 477, 487–488 (1975). By requiring the Jaycees to admit women as full voting members, the Minnesota Act works an infringement of the last type. There can be no clearer example of an intrusion into the internal structure or affairs of an association than a regulation that forces the group to accept members it does not desire. Such a regulation may impair the ability of the original members to express only those views that brought them together. Freedom of association therefore plainly presupposes a freedom not to associate. See *Abood* v. *Detroit Board of Education*, *supra*, at 234–235.

The right to associate for expressive purposes is not, however, absolute. Infringements on that right may be justified by regulations adopted to serve compelling state interests, unrelated to the suppression of ideas, that cannot be achieved through means significantly less restrictive of associational freedoms. *E. g.*, *Brown* v. *Socialist Workers '74 Campaign Committee*, *supra*, at 91–92; *Democratic Party of United States* v. *Wisconsin*, 450 U. S. 107, 124 (1981); *Buckley* v. *Valeo*, 424 U. S. 1, 25 (1976) *(per curiam)*; *Cousins* v. *Wigoda*, *supra*, at 489; *American Party of Texas* v. *White*, 415 U. S. 767, 780–781 (1974); *NAACP* v. *Button*, *supra*, at 438; *Shelton* v. *Tucker*, 364 U. S. 479, 486, 488 (1960). We are persuaded that Minnesota's compelling interest in eradicating discrimination against its female citizens justifies the impact that application of the statute to the Jaycees may have on the male members' associational freedoms.

On its face, the Minnesota Act does not aim at the suppression of speech, does not distinguish between prohibited and permitted activity on the basis of viewpoint, and does not license enforcement authorities to administer the statute on the basis of such constitutionally impermissible criteria. See